READING PASSAGE 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.

Carnivorous plants

They attract insects and then eat their flesh. Is that any way for a plant to behave?

The naturalist and author of *On the Origin of Species*, Charles Darwin, was fascinated by carnivorous plants. In 1860, soon after he came across his first carnivorous plant — the sundew, *Drosera* — he wrote, 'I care more about *Drosera* than the origin of all the species in the world.' He spent months running experiments on the plants. He dropped flies and bits of meat on their leaves and watched them slowly fold their sticky tentacles over their prey. He thought it incredible that brushing a leaf with a single strand of human hair was enough to bring about a response. Yet sundews, he observed, ignored raindrops. To react to such a false alarm, he reasoned, would obviously be a great evil to the plant. This was no accident. This was adaptation.

Darwin expanded his studies from sundews to other species in his book *Insectivorous Plants*. He was amazed at the thickness and power of the Venus flytrap. He showed that when one of its leaves snapped shut, it formed itself into a temporary 'stomach', secreting enzymes that could dissolve the prey. He noted that a leaf took more than a week to reopen after closing, and reasoned that the interlocking spines along the margin of the leaf allowed tiny insects to escape, saving the plant the expense of digesting an insufficient meal.

Today, biologists using 21st-century tools to study cells and DNA are beginning to understand how these plants hunt, eat, and digest — and how these strange adaptations came about in the first place. Alexander Volkov, a plant physiologist at Oakwood University in Alabama, believes he has figured out the Venus flytrap's secret. 'This,' Volkov declares, 'is an electrical plant.'

When an insect brushes against a hair on the leaf of a Venus flytrap, the movement sets off an electric charge. The charge builds up inside the tissue of the leaf but is not enough to stimulate the snap, which keeps the Venus flytrap from reacting to false alarms, such as raindrops. An insect, however, is likely to brush a second hair, adding enough electric charge for the leaf to close.

Volkov's experiments reveal that the electric charge travels down fluid-filled tunnels in a leaf, which opens up pores in cell membranes. Water rushes from the cells on the inside of the leaf to those on the outside, causing the leaf to rapidly flip in shape from convex to concave, like a soft contact lens. As the leaves flip, they snap together, trapping an insect inside.

The bladderwort plant has an equally sophisticated way of setting its underwater trap. It pumps water out of tiny air sacs or bladders, lowering the pressure inside. When a water flea or some other small creature swims past, it bends hairs on the bladder, causing a flap to spring apart. The low pressure sucks water in, carrying the creature along with it. In one five-hundredth of a second, the flap swings shut again. The cells in the bladder then begin to pump water out again, creating a new vacuum.

Many other species of carnivorous plants act like living flypaper, catching animals on sticky tentacles. Pitcher plants use yet another strategy, growing long tube-shaped leaves into which insects fall. Some of the largest have pitchers up to 30cm deep and can consume whole frogs unlucky enough to fall into them. Sophisticated chemistry helps make the pitcher a death trap.

Nicholas Gotelli, of the University of Vermont, is trying to figure out what evolutionary forces pushed these plants towards meat. Carnivorous plants clearly benefit from eating animals; when scientists feed pitcher plants extra bugs, the plants get bigger. But the benefits of eating flesh are not the ones you might expect.

Carnivorous animals, like ourselves, use the carbon in protein and the fat in meat to build muscles and store energy. Carnivorous plants, however, take nitrogen and phosphorus from the flesh in order to build light-harvesting enzymes. Eating animals, in other words, lets carnivorous plants do what all plants do: grow by taking energy directly from the sun.

Unfortunately, they do a really bad job of it. That's because they have to use a lot of energy to make the equipment they need to catch animals — the enzymes, the pumps, the sticky tentacles, and so on. A pitcher or a flytrap is not very good at photosynthesis because, unlike plants with ordinary leaves, it does not have flat solar panels that can absorb lots of sunlight.

Gotelli suspects that only under special conditions are the benefits of being carnivorous greater than the costs. The poor soil of bogs and swamps, where many carnivorous plants grow, offers little nitrogen and phosphorus, so carnivorous plants enjoy an advantage there over 'conventional' plants. Also, bogs are often flooded with sunshine, so even an inefficient carnivorous plant can carry out enough photosynthesis to survive. 'They're stuck, and they're making the best of it,' says Aaron Ellison of Harvard University.

Unfortunately, the adaptations that enable carnivorous plants to survive in harsh habitats also make them extremely sensitive to environmental changes. Chemical fertilizers used in agriculture and pollution from power plants are adding extra nitrogen to many bogs in North America. Carnivorous plants are so finely adapted to low levels of nitrogen that this extra fertilizer is overloading their systems.

Humans also threaten carnivorous plants in other ways. The black market trade in exotic carnivorous plants is strong, but even if this can be prevented, carnivorous plants will continue to suffer from other dangers. Their habitat is disappearing, to be replaced by shopping centers and houses. The suppression of wildfires by government agencies allows other plants to grow quickly and outcompete the Venus flytraps. Good news, perhaps, for flies. But a loss for all who delight in the inventiveness of evolution.

Questions 1–5

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 1–5 on your answer sheet.

Carnivorous Plants

Darwin's experiments:

Drosera

- He put insects and small amounts of meat onto leaves and observed what happened.
- He was amazed that one human hair triggered a response.
- He understood why the plant did not respond to **1.** _____

Venus flytrap

- He demonstrated how leaves close and then, for a short period, act like a **2.** _____
- He noted the structure of the leaves ensures small insects are released.

Biology today:

Venus flytrap

- If insects come into contact with leaf hairs, their movement produces an electric charge.
- The charge enters fluid-filled tunnels, causing **3.** _____ in cell membranes to open.
- Water moves between cells and then the leaf changes from convex to concave, trapping the insect inside.

Bladderwort

- Hairs bend when insects swim past, resulting in the opening of a flap.
- Water is sucked in.
- When water is pumped out of bladder cells, a **4. _____** builds up inside.

Pitcher plants

- The plants have tube-shaped leaves that insects fall into.
- Some plants are big enough to capture and eat **5. _____**

Questions 6–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 6–13 on your answer sheet, write:

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

6. Pitcher plants increase in size after they have digested a lot of insects.

7. Carnivorous plants produce light-harvesting enzymes with the nutrients they extract from animals.

8. Pitcher plants and Venus flytraps are more efficient at photosynthesis than plants with ordinary leaves.

9. Venus flytraps are better adapted to the soil of swamps and bogs than other carnivorous plants.

10. Carnivorous plants frequently find it difficult to photosynthesise in bogs due to a lack of sunlight.

11. Scientists have campaigned to reduce the amount of nitrogen that is released into the soil by agricultural practices.

12. A lot of exotic carnivorous plants are sold illegally.

13. Preventing wildfires is beneficial to the Venus flytrap.

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. raindrops (Darwin nhận thấy cây gọng vó lờ đi các giọt nước mưa để tránh báo động giả) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Yet sundews, he observed, ignored raindrops. To react to such a false alarm, he reasoned, would obviously be a great evil to the plant. This was no accident. This was adaptation.

2. stomach (Lá cây bẫy kẹp Venus sau khi đóng lại sẽ đóng vai trò như một cái dạ dày tạm thời).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

He showed that when one of its leaves snapped shut, it formed itself into a temporary ‘stomach’.

3. pores (Điện tích chạy qua các ống dẫn dịch làm mở các lỗ trên màng tế bào) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

……electric charge travels down fluid-filled tunnels in a leaf, which opens up pores in cell membranes.

4. vacuum (Khi nước được bơm ra khỏi tế bào túi, một môi trường chân không sẽ được tạo ra bên trong) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The cells in the bladder then begin to pump water out again, creating a new vacuum.

5. frogs (Một số loài cây nắp ấm lớn có thể bắt và ăn thịt cả những con ếch) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Some of the largest have pitchers up to 30cm deep and can consume whole frogs unlucky enough to fall into them.

6. TRUE (Văn bản xác nhận khi được cho ăn thêm côn trùng, cây nắp ấm sẽ trở nên lớn hơn) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Carnivorous plants clearly benefit from eating animals; when scientists feed pitcher plants extra bugs, the plants get bigger.

7. TRUE (Thực vật ăn thịt lấy nitơ và phốt pho từ thịt động vật để xây dựng các enzyme thu hoạch ánh sáng) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Carnivorous plants, however, take nitrogen and phosphorus from the flesh in order to build light-harvesting enzymes.

8. FALSE (Cây nắp ấm và bẫy kẹp Venus quang hợp kém hiệu quả hơn các loài cây có lá bình thường).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

A pitcher or a flytrap is not very good at photosynthesis because, unlike plants with ordinary leaves, they do not have flat solar panels that can absorb lots of sunlight.

9. NOT GIVEN (Bài đọc chỉ nói thực vật ăn thịt nói chung có lợi thế ở vùng đầm lầy, không so sánh mức độ thích nghi giữa cây bẫy kẹp và các loài cây ăn thịt khác) .

Giải thích:

Bài có nói rằng các loài cây ăn thịt nói chung sống tốt ở đầm lầy nghèo dinh dưỡng, nhưng không so sánh riêng Venus flytrap với các loài khác.

10. FALSE (Vùng đầm lầy thường tràn ngập ánh nắng mặt trời, nên cây vẫn có thể quang hợp để tồn tại) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Also, bogs are often flooded with sunshine, so even an inefficient carnivorous plant can carry out enough photosynthesis to survive.

11. NOT GIVEN (Bài đọc nhắc đến tác hại của phân bón hóa học nhưng không đề cập đến việc các nhà khoa học có thực hiện chiến dịch cắt giảm chúng hay không) .

12. TRUE (Thị trường chợ đen buôn bán các loài cây ăn thịt kỳ lạ đang hoạt động mạnh mẽ) .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The black market trade in exotic carnivorous plants is strong...

13. FALSE (Việc ngăn chặn cháy rừng cho phép các loài cây khác phát triển nhanh và cạnh tranh trực tiếp với cây bẫy kẹp Venus) .

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

Stress Less

How busy is too busy? For some it means sometimes having to have a short lunch; for others it may mean missing lunch altogether. For a few, it is not being able to take a day off once a month. Then there is a group of people for whom working every evening and weekend is normal, and feeling stressed is taken for granted. For most senior executives, workloads swing between extremely busy and frenzied. Neil Plumridge, vice-president of a management consultancy company, says that his weeks vary from a 'manageable' 45 hours to 80 hours, but average 60 hours.

Three signs warn Plumridge about his workload: sleep, scheduling and family. He knows he is doing too much when he gets less than six hours' sleep for three consecutive nights, when he is constantly having to reschedule appointments, and when he misses a family birthday or anniversary. 'Then,' he says, 'I know things are out of control.' Plumridge states that stress is often caused by his having unrealistic expectations of himself. 'I'll promise a client that I'll do something tomorrow, and then I'll promise another client that I'll do the same thing, when I know it's not going to happen. I could have said: "Why don't I give that to you in 48 hours?" The client wouldn't care.'

Over-committing is something people experience as an individual problem. However, new research indicates that people may be designed to over-commit. A study in the *Journal of Experimental Psychology* shows that people always believe that they will be less busy in the future. This is a misapprehension according to the authors of the report, Gal Zauberman of the University of North Carolina and John Lynch of Duke University. 'On average, an individual will be just as busy two weeks or a month from now as he or she is today. But that is not how it appears in everyday life,' they say. 'People make commitments long in advance that they would never make if the same commitments required immediate action. They discount future time investments relatively steeply.'

Being 'too busy' is highly subjective, but for any individual there are some concrete signs of stress: disturbed sleep and declining mental and physical health are the most common examples. Figures for National Workers' Compensation (insurance against injury caused by work) show that stress causes the most loss of time of any workplace injury: employees suffering stress are absent from work for an average of 16.6 weeks. The effects of stress are also expensive. The Australian Government insurer reports that, in 2003–2004, claims for stress-related psychological injury accounted for 7% of insurance claims, but almost 27% of the amount paid out in claim payments.

Experts say the key to dealing with stress is not to focus on relief — a game of golf or a massage — but to reassess workloads. Neil Plumridge says he makes it a priority to work out what has to change: that might mean allocating extra staff to a job, allowing more time, or changing expectations. He also relies on the advice of colleagues, saying that his peers

coach each other on business problems: ‘Just a fresh pair of eyes over an issue can help,’ he states.

Executive stress is not confined to big organisations. Vanessa Stoykov has been running her own advertising agency and public relations business for seven years. Her company has grown so fast that it appeared on the *Business Review Weekly* ‘Fast 100’ list of fastest-growing small enterprises in 2004, just after Stoykov had her first child. In 2005, revenue was projected to double to $2.4 million. She had just had her second child. With a fast-growing business and two small children, Stoykov says she has mastered the art of caring for children, typing, and talking on the phone at the same time. But, unlike many others, she appears to thrive on the mental stimulation of running her own business, despite the stress.

Jan Elsner, a psychologist who specialises in executive coaching, says that doing well on a demanding workload is typical of senior executives. Some people work best with high-adrenaline periods followed by quieter times, while others thrive under sustained pressure. Elsner’s practice is based on a movement known as positive psychology, a school of thought that argues that positive experiences — feeling engaged and challenged, for example — do not balance out negative experiences such as stress; instead they help people increase their resilience over time. Elsner says that many of the senior business people she coaches are increasingly relying more on regulating stress through methods such as meditation. She points to research showing that meditation can alter the biochemistry of the brain and the way that brains and bodies react to stress.

Some experts believe there is too much emphasis on treating job stress as an individual problem. Tony LaMontagne, of the University of Melbourne, says that while personality traits do have some effect on stress, it is systemic stressors — qualities of job roles and organisations themselves — that have a far greater effect. His recent research shows that the major predictor of stress is the level of job control a person has. The best type of job combines challenging work with high autonomy. The worst jobs combine challenging work and low control. People with demanding jobs but little autonomy have up to four times the probability of depression and more than double the risk of heart attack.

Questions 14–18

Look at the following statements (Questions 14–18) and the list of people below.

Match each statement with the correct person, ***A–D****.*

Write the correct letter, ***A–D****, in boxes 14–18 on your answer sheet.*

NB *You may use any letter more than once.*

14 High-level workers tend to react positively to stress

15 Stress levels are increased by trying to please customers

16 Support from other workers may relieve stress

17 Lack of independence at work is often responsible for stress

18 Workers commonly expect their workloads to lessen over time

List of People

A Neil Plumridge
B Gal Zauberman and John Lynch
C Jan Elsner
D Tony LaMontagne

TRUE IELTS

Questions 19–21

*Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C or D**.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 19–21 on your answer sheet.

19 Which of the following is **NOT** mentioned by Neil Plumridge as an indication that his workload is too heavy?

A an inability to keep to his schedule
B inattention to family celebrations
C a lack of concentration on a task
D a period of insufficient sleep

20 Which method of lessening work stress is **NOT** suggested by Neil Plumridge?

A rethinking ideas of what can be achieved
B extending the deadline for completing the task
C using more workers on a project
D taking more time off for sport or other recreation

21 According to Jan Elsner, meditation offers a method of

A taking a worker's mind off his troubles.
B changing the physical response to stress.
C resting more effectively.
D encouraging executives to take breaks.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 22–26

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 22–26 on your answer sheet.

Stress: its effects and how to reduce it

Statistics on workers' compensation show that people take more time off work due to stress than for any other **22** _____ at work. On average, workers who take time off because of stress stay away for **23** _____. This absence comes at a high price — while the number of insurance claims due to stress amount to only **24** _____ of the total, they account for a much higher proportion of the cost of claim payments.

Experts believe that seeking to relieve stress through physical therapies such as sport or **25** _____ may be less effective than simply reviewing your **26** _____.

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. C (Jan Elsner: Những người làm việc ở cấp độ cao có xu hướng phản ứng tích cực với áp lực công việc)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Elsner's practice is based on a movement known as positive psychology, a school of thought that argues that positive experiences – feeling engaged and challenged, for example – do not balance out negative experiences such as stress; instead they help people increase their resilience over time. Elsner says that many of the senior business people she coaches are increasingly relying more on regulating stress through methods such as meditation

15. A (Neil Plumridge: Mức độ căng thẳng tăng lên do cố gắng làm hài lòng khách hàng bằng những hứa hẹn không thực tế)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

I'll promise a client that I'll do something tomorrow, and then I'll promise another client that I'll do the same thing, when I know it's not going to happen. I could have said: "Why don't I give that to you in 48 hours?" The client wouldn't care.'

16. A (Neil Plumridge: Sự hỗ trợ/tư vấn từ đồng nghiệp có thể giúp giảm bớt căng thẳng)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Neil Plumridge says he makes it a priority to work out what has to change: that might mean allocating extra staff to a job, allowing more time, or changing expectations. He also relies on the advice of colleagues, saying that his peers coach each other on business problems: 'Just a fresh pair of eyes over an issue can help,' he states.

17. D (Tony LaMontagne: Việc thiếu sự tự chủ/độc lập trong công việc thường là nguyên nhân gây ra căng thẳng)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

His recent research shows that the major predictor of stress is the level of job control a person has. The best type of job combines challenging work with high autonomy. The worst jobs combine challenging work and low control. People with demanding jobs but little autonomy have up to four times the probability of depression and more than double the risk of heart attack.

18. B (Gal Zauberman và John Lynch: Công nhân thường tin rằng họ sẽ bớt bận rộn hơn trong tương lai)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

'On average, an individual will be just as busy two weeks or a month from now as he or she is today. But that is not how it appears in everyday life,' they say. 'People make commitments long in advance that they would never make if the same commitments required immediate action. They discount future time investments relatively steeply.'

19. C (Neil Plumridge không đề cập đến việc "thiếu tập trung" là dấu hiệu quá tải; ông chỉ nhắc đến giấc ngủ, lịch trình và gia đình)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

He knows he is doing too much when he gets less than six hours' sleep for three consecutive nights, when he is constantly having to reschedule appointments, and when he misses a family birthday or anniversary

20. D (Ông đề xuất phân bổ thêm nhân viên, thêm thời gian, thay đổi kỳ vọng, nhưng **không** đề xuất nghỉ thêm để chơi thể thao hay giải trí)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Experts say the key to dealing with stress is not to focus on relief – a game of golf or a massage – but to reassess workloads... that might mean allocating extra staff to a job, allowing more time, or changing expectations.

21. B (Theo Jan Elsner, thiền giúp thay đổi phản ứng sinh hóa của não và cơ thể đối với căng thẳng)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

She points to research showing that meditation can alter the biochemistry of the brain and the way that brains and bodies react to stress

22. workplace injury (Dữ liệu cho thấy mọi người nghỉ việc do căng thẳng nhiều hơn bất kỳ **chấn thương tại nơi làm việc** nào khác)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Figures for National Workers' Compensation (insurance against injury caused by work) show that stress causes the most lost time of any workplace injury: employees suffering stress are absent from work for an average of 16.6 weeks

23. 16.6 weeks (Trung bình nhân viên nghỉ do căng thẳng trong **16,6 tuần**)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Employees suffering stress are absent from work for an average of 16.6 weeks.

24. 7% (Yêu cầu bồi thường do căng thẳng chỉ chiếm **7%** tổng số yêu cầu)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

claims for stress-related psychological injury accounted for 7% of insurance claims,

25. massage (Các liệu pháp vật lý như thể thao hoặc **massage** có thể ít hiệu quả hơn)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Experts say the key to dealing with stress is not to focus on relief – a game of golf or a massage – but to reassess workloads

26. workloads (Việc xem xét lại **khối lượng công việc** hiệu quả hơn các liệu pháp giảm căng thẳng tạm thời)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Experts say the key to dealing with stress is not to focus on relief – a game of golf or a massage – but to reassess workloads

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

Robert Louis Stevenson

The writer of some of the best-known stories in the English language, including Treasure Island and The Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde

It is more than 100 years since the death of the Scottish writer Robert Louis Stevenson on the South Pacific island of Samoa, and it seems that time has not been kind to Stevenson's memory. Immediately after his death, his family and friends set to work to fashion the legend of Robert Louis Stevenson, or R. L. S., as he became known, one of the few writers familiar from his initials alone. Subsequent works of biography then turned him into a writer of almost religious importance. One example was literary critic Balfour, who in 1901 portrayed Stevenson's family as ministering angels to the dying genius during his final illness. Similarly, the biographer Crouch absurdly overstated Stevenson's significance by placing him in the same company as those most revered names in English literature: Shakespeare and Keats. The reaction to this nonsense was a number of highly critical assessments of Stevenson's legacy in the 1920s.

Normally, the critical pendulum can be relied on to swing back again, but there are several aspects of Stevenson's work that have, until recently, acted against a more balanced appraisal. First is the allegation that Stevenson was a mere master of linguistic fireworks, who lacked moral depth. Some critics accused him of being a literary charlatan, of juggling words very prettily to strike effects which overawed an ignorant public, and served to distract from the inadequacy of his ideas.

Then there has long been a prejudice against the adventure story as the proper medium for deep moral seriousness, a prejudice which is still extremely influential today. It seems that we can accept that an adventure film can successfully express profound moral truths, but we reject the same idea for a book. The absurdity of this becomes apparent when we think of writers like Joseph Conrad and Graham Greene, but it is no use pretending that this bias against adventure stories is not part of our high culture. A further problem is that Stevenson has often not found favour in the land of his birth because his conservatism so often collides with the strong radical tradition in Scotland. His many escapist stories and preference for living abroad have led to accusations that he camouflaged Scotland's problems. Lastly, the high adventure of Stevenson's own lifestyle has sometimes obscured his output, his life a greater story than any he could devise. This was precisely what his friends feared would happen towards the end of his short life: his art might be overwhelmed by the drama of life in Samoa.

One consequence of this has been that Stevenson's influence on other writers has too often been neglected. The writer and poet Oscar Wilde was deeply influenced by Stevenson, even though he declared that Stevenson would have produced better work if he had lived in London rather than Samoa. Stevenson tends to stick in the throat even of those writers who

would like to spit him out, such as Shaw, who claimed to have learned from him that the romantic hero is always mocked by reality. Likewise, the writer Galsworthy, who began as a determined critic, later changed his mind and said that the superiority of Stevenson over the novelist Hardy was that Stevenson was all life and Hardy all death. The influence on the novelist Chesterton would also repay detailed study, for it was through him that Stevenson has managed to cross the ages, emerging as an influence on the modernist movement and our own contemporary Latin American school of “magical realism”.

When making an assessment of his life and work one question must inevitably be asked: was Robert Louis Stevenson Scotland’s greatest writer of English prose? For most commentators this honour falls to Sir Walter Scott, author of *Ivanhoe* among many other classic novels, and it is true that in terms of craftsmanship, precision and the ability to minutely regulate language to create the desired effect, Scott takes the prize. However, this is not the same thing at all as inherent talent; by way of comparison one may take the example of the two great Russian composers Shostakovich and Prokofiev, of whom the former had learned more precise skills of execution but the latter’s intrinsic genius was greater, and so it seems to be with Scott and Stevenson. Admittedly, Scott’s detailed style does permit his stories to explore levels of tragedy that are beyond Stevenson’s reach, but in this regard they have the musty smell of the museum, somehow artificial and removed from modern day reality. On the other hand, Stevenson’s skill with plotting and narrative gives his books a timeless quality, so that they still live today, and Stevenson was also the shrewder judge of behaviour and psychology. For example, his compelling descriptions of a man with a split personality in *The Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde* have proved so accessible and accurate that the expression “Jekyll and Hyde” has entered common English usage. Even if we do not see a revival of critical interest in this great Scottish writer, it is to be hoped that readers go back to Robert Louis Stevenson’s magnificent stories and reassess this neglected genius.

Questions 27–31

*Choose the correct letter **A, B, C or D**.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 27–31 on your answer sheet.

27 In the opinion of the writer, the biographers Balfour and Crouch

A understated the role played by Stevenson's family.
B misunderstood Stevenson's religious beliefs.
C overestimated other writers' influence on Stevenson.
D elevated Stevenson above his true status as a writer.

28 What is the writer's main point about Stevenson in the second paragraph?

A The public judged him more fairly than the critics.
B Recent criticism of him has been justified.
C Critics argued that his style covered up his faults.
D The ethical nature of his stories was often criticized.

29 According to the writer, the adventure story

A is more appropriate for books than films.
B can be used by writers to tell moral stories.
C is more fashionable today than in the past.
D has been used by other writers but not Stevenson.

30 What point does the writer make about Stevenson and Scotland?

A His ideas contrasted with those of many Scots.
B He demonstrated great sympathy for Scotland's problems.
C He was not considered a true Scot as he was not born there.
D His unflattering stories about Scotland angered many Scots.

31 According to the writer, Stevenson's own lifestyle

A was envied by his friends.
B was responsible for his early death.
C attracted more attention than his books.
D did not prepare him for living in Samoa.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 32–35

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 32–35 on your answer sheet write

YES — if the statement agrees with the views of the writer
NO — if the statement contradicts the views of the writer
NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

32 Although Oscar Wilde admired Stevenson's work, he believed Stevenson could have written something better.

33 Stevenson encouraged Oscar Wilde to start writing.

34 Galsworthy had greater respect for Hardy than Stevenson.

35 More research is needed regarding Stevenson's influence on Chesterton.

Questions 36–40

*Complete the summary using the list of words and phrases, **A–I**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–I**, in boxes 36–40 on your answer sheet.*

Robert Louis Stevenson and Sir Walter Scott

Opinions differ as to whether Robert Louis Stevenson or Sir Walter Scott should be considered Scotland's best writer. Scott had greater **36** _____, but Stevenson had more **37** _____, and the same distinction can be made between the two composers Shostakovich and Prokofiev. It is true that Scott's books showed more **38** _____ when it came to tragedy, though in an old-fashioned way, while Stevenson's books are still popular because of his **39** _____. And Stevenson's understanding of **40** _____ has resulted in the widespread use of an expression from one of his books.

A natural ability
B critical acclaim
C humour
D romance
E colourful language
F technical control
G storytelling
H depth
I human nature

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. D (elevated Stevenson above his true status as a writer)

Giải thích: Balfour mô tả gia đình Stevenson như "những thiên thần hộ mệnh", còn Crouch so sánh ông với Shakespeare và Keats (những cái tên được tôn sùng nhất), điều mà tác giả gọi là "vô lý"
Đoạn chứa đáp án: One example was literary critic Balfour, who in 1901 portrayed Stevenson's family as ministering angels to the dying genius during his final illness. Similarly, the biographer Crouch absurdly overstated Stevenson's significance by placing him in the same company as those most revered names in English literature: Shakespeare and Keats. The reaction to this nonsense was a number of highly critical assessments of Stevenson's legacy in the 1920s.

28. C (Critics argued that his style covered up his faults)

Giải thích: Các nhà phê bình cáo buộc ông là "kẻ bịp bợm văn chương", dùng lời lẽ hoa mỹ để đánh lừa công chúng và che đậy sự thiếu hụt về ý tưởng .
Đoạn chứa đáp án: Some critics accused him of being a literary charlatan, of juggling words very prettily to strike effects which overawed an ignorant public, and served to distract from the inadequacy of his ideas.

29. B (can be used by writers to tell moral stories)

Giải thích: Tác giả đề cập rằng truyện phiêu lưu có thể là phương tiện cho "chiều sâu đạo đức nghiêm túc", tương tự như phim ảnh hay tác phẩm của Joseph Conrad
Đoạn chứa đáp án: Then there has long been a prejudice against the adventure story as the proper medium for deep moral seriousness, a prejudice which is still extremely influential today. It seems that we can accept that an adventure film can successfully express profound moral truths, but we reject the same idea for a book. The absurdity of this becomes apparent when we think of writers like Joseph Conrad and Graham Greene, but it is no use pretending that this bias against adventure stories is not part of our high culture.

30. A (His ideas contrasted with those of many Scots)

Giải thích: Sự bảo thủ của ông thường xung đột với truyền thống cấp tiến mạnh mẽ ở Scotland

Đoạn chứa đáp án: A further problem is that Stevenson has often not found favour in the land of his birth because his conservatism so often collides with the strong radical tradition in Scotland. His many escapist stories and preference for living abroad have led to accusations that he camouflaged Scotland's health problems.

31. C (attracted more attention than his books)

Giải thích: Cuộc đời đầy phiêu lưu của Stevenson đôi khi làm lu mờ các tác phẩm của ông; nghệ thuật của ông bị lấn át bởi kịch tính của cuộc sống tại Samoa

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Lastly the high adventure of Stevenson's own lifestyle has sometimes obscured his output. His globe- trotting, and above all the final phase of his life in Samoa, tended to make his own life a greater story than any he could devise.

32. YES

Giải thích: Oscar Wilde chịu ảnh hưởng sâu sắc nhưng tuyên bố Stevenson lẽ ra đã có những tác phẩm tốt hơn nếu sống ở London thay vì Samoa

Đoạn chứa đáp án: The writer and poet Oscar Wilde was deeply influenced by Stevenson, even though he declared that Stevenson would have produced better work if he had lived in London rather than Samoa

33. NOT GIVEN

Giải thích: Bài đọc chỉ nói Wilde chịu ảnh hưởng bởi Stevenson, không đề cập việc Stevenson khuyến khích Wilde bắt đầu viết lách

Đoạn chứa đáp án: The writer and poet Oscar Wilde was deeply influenced by Stevenson

34. NO

Giải thích: Galsworthy cho rằng Stevenson ưu việt hơn Hardy vì Stevenson là "tất cả sự sống" còn Hardy là "tất cả cái chết"
Đoạn chứa đáp án: Likewise, the writer Galsworthy, who began as a determined critic, later changed his mind and said that the superiority of Stevenson over the novelist Hardy was that Stevenson was all life and Hardy all death

35. YES

Giải thích: Tác giả khẳng định tầm ảnh hưởng đối với Chesterton "xứng đáng được nghiên cứu chi tiết" (would repay detailed study)
Đoạn chứa đáp án: The influence on the novelist Chesterton would also repay detailed study, for it was through him that Stevenson has managed to cross the ages, emerging as an influence on the modernist movement and our own contemporary Latin American school of 'magical realism'.

36. F (technical control)

Giải thích: Scott được đánh giá cao về "craftsmanship, precision" (tay nghề, sự chính xác)
Đoạn chứa đáp án: in terms of craftsmanship, precision and the ability to minutely regulate language to create the desired effect, Scott takes the Prize.

37. A (natural ability)

Giải thích: Tác giả so sánh Stevenson với Prokofiev, người có "năng khiếu bẩm sinh" (intrinsic genius/inherent talent) lớn hơn
Đoạn chứa đáp án: by way of comparison one may take the example of the two great Russian composers Shostakovich and Prokofiev, of whom the former had learned more precise skills of execution but the latter's intrinsic genius was greater, and so it seems to be with Scott and Stevenson.

38. H (depth)

Giải thích: Phong cách của Scott cho phép ông khám phá các cấp độ bi kịch (levels of tragedy) sâu sắc hơn

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Admittedly, Scott's detailed style does permit his stories to explore levels of tragedy that are beyond Stevenson's reach.

39. G (storytelling)

Giải thích: Kỹ năng xây dựng cốt truyện và dẫn chuyện (plotting and narrative) giúp sách của Stevenson có giá trị vượt thời gian

Đoạn chứa đáp án: On the other hand, Stevenson's skill with plotting and narrative give his books a timeless quality.

40. I (human nature)

Giải thích: Sự thấu hiểu về hành vi và tâm lý (behavior and psychology) giúp cụm từ "Jekyll and Hyde" trở nên phổ biến

Đoạn chứa đáp án: And Stevenson was also the shrewder judge of behaviour and psychology